An orbit is continuous falling

antocciphysics

Name: _____ **Block:** _____ (teacher only) **Mastery Rating:** _____

LEARNING TARGET Explain a circular orbit with gravity and sideways motion.

SUCCESS CRITERIA - I can...

1. Describe orbit as free fall rather than absent gravity.
2. Distinguish tangent velocity from inward force.
3. Connect circular speed to orbital radius.

Core: teacher selects from 1-7. **Stretch:** 8 after checking your work.

MARZANO SELF-CHECK

① Need help starting

② Can do part; need help

③ Solve and explain with allowed supports

01 Bring back an earlier idea

A ball launched horizontally at 6 m/s stays airborne 4 s. Find its landing point measured horizontally from the platform base.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

02 Explain a worked example

Reference: $GM/r^2 = v^2/r$; $v = \sqrt{(GM/r)}$.
Circular orbit outside a spherical body of mass M; r is orbital radius. Neglect atmosphere and other bodies.

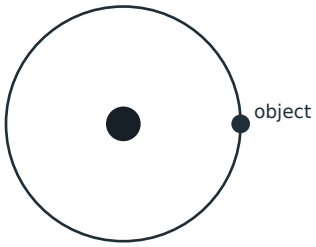
Worked reasoning: A toy circular orbit has radius 4 m and speed 2 m/s. Its period is circumference/speed=$2\pi \times 4/2 = 4\pi$ s. Gravity continuously changes the velocity direction.

Your turn: Draw a quarter-orbit with tangent velocity arrows and inward gravitational arrows.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

03 Look and explain

Draw the path of an orbiting object and its velocity/force arrows. Explain how it can fall without immediately hitting the surface.



The center is the attracting body; the small dot on the circle is the orbiting object.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

04 Build the solution

Model A has orbital period 8 s. How many orbits occur in 24 s? If an object covers a 40 m circumference in 8 s, find its average speed.

Marzano check - circle: ① ② ③

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Continue down each column.

05 Use the idea

Why does a rocket not need to keep firing forward to remain in an ideal circular orbit?

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

06 Choose a method

A rover travels around a bend at a steady 6 m/s. Describe an observation that shows velocity changes even though the speed reading does not.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

07 Exit check

Is an orbiting satellite accelerating if its speed is constant? Draw an arrow to support your answer.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3

08 STRETCH: Apply it another way

Compare two toy orbits with the same speed but radii 2 and 4 m. Which takes longer, and by what factor? State that this is a kinematic comparison, not necessarily two orbits around the same body.

Marzano check - circle: 1 2 3